

Overstaying Their Welcome: Unevictable Tenants, Rents, and Home Prices

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The paper in one slide.

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A **very informative paper** that confirms economic intuition.

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The current structure:

- ① What I did.
- ② Why I did it.
- ③ How I did it.
- ④ How I did all of the robustness stuff.
- ⑤ Here's all of the results.
 - The results section starts on page 24 **after** all of the tests have been thoroughly explained.

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Suggested structure:

- ➊ What I did and why it's important.
- ➋ How I did the main test.
- ➌ **What the main test says. RESULTS.**
- ➍ Why and How I do robustness test A.
- ➎ **What robustness test A results say. RESULTS.**
- ➏ Why and How I do robustness test B.
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I think a referee will be more comfortable with this structure and more favorable to the results.

Major Point 2

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- The paper has 1 table and 1 figure that includes rents.
- But the change in rents is really interesting and deserves more attention.
 - Caveat: maybe I don't understand the data well enough... maybe you can't do much more with rent.

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II. Data Description

I utilize publicly available data from the Zillow Home Value Index (“ZHVI”) to obtain rental prices and home value data for all states within the United States. (Zillow 2022). The index contains smoothed, seasonally adjusted valuation of everything from condominiums, one-bedroom single-family homes, to five-bedroom single-family homes. The index also provides rental prices for specific regions, typically denoted by zip code or metropolitan statistical area (“MSA”). Zillow intends for this index to provide home values for homes between the 35th and the 65th percentile range. This data is therefore naturally truncated at these levels. Data for top-

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Does this bias estimates in some way? Which way?

Major Point 4

The sample should be extended.

- Have rents actually gone up in Virginia now?
- Have home values recovered yet?

Some Minor Points

- ① Bootstrap standard errors.
 - Given the small sample size with time and states, it may make sense to bootstrap.
- ② For Figures 1 through 10, make sure they have the same y-axis scale so we can compare them adequately.
- ③ You told us about pre-trends in the paper, but then didn't show us the pre-trends for quite some time after that.

Recap in one slide.

Very nice tests, results, and evidence of economic mechanisms.